

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Friendship Bridge

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: teamwork.

For use in your own home. Please don’t share the file or post it online.

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For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

When we put our ideas together, we can do more than either of us could alone.

The big line

“Together, we can do more.”

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
bridge	something you build to cross over water or a gap	make an arch with your arm
log	a big, heavy piece of a tree trunk	hold your arms out wide and heavy
branch	a thin, bendy part of a tree	wiggle one arm like a branch
argue	to disagree with cross words	put your hands on your hips and shake your head
together	with each other	lace your fingers together

A gentle note

Neither friend is right or wrong. Keep the message that both ideas had something good.

Real-life safety: never build or cross homemade bridges over real rivers. Keep bridge-building to tables and sandboxes.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Venny

North American beaver

A beaver who learns that building together is better



Sammy

American red squirrel

Venny's friend, who helps build the bridge

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How did they feel?

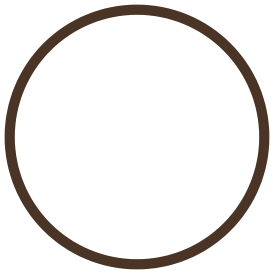
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The giant strawberry bush across the river.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

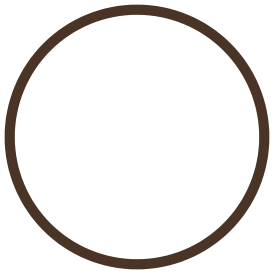


Moment 2

‘Your idea didn’t work!’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

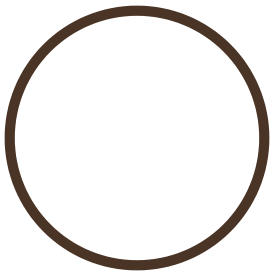


Moment 3

They laugh and cheer as they work.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

bridge something you build to cross over water or a gap

bridge bridge

log a big, heavy piece of a tree trunk

log log

branch a thin, bendy part of a tree

branch branch

Venny the hero of the story

Venny Venny

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Venny showed teamwork. Draw a time when you showed teamwork too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Build a bridge together

You need: Craft sticks, string or rubber bands, two books with a gap between

Each partner tries building a bridge across the gap alone: one with only sticks, one with only string. Then build one together using both. Test it with a toy figure. Talk about what worked.

Build a bridge together

Use blocks, sticks or paper to build a bridge with a friend. Who did which job?

Beaver chew

Crunch a carrot and think about a beaver's strong teeth. Theirs never stop growing!

Cone count

Collect pine cones on a walk. How many could you store, like a red squirrel?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Friendship Bridge are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Venny

North American beaver

A beaver dam found in Alberta in 2007 is 850 metres long! Beavers had worked on it for years.



Sammy

American red squirrel

A midden of cone scales can grow up to 12 metres across.

Story or real?

Real beavers really are master builders, but they build dams and lodges, not bridges. Working together is real, though: a beaver family shares its home.

Where they really live

The book's river has no name, so we picked Algonquin Park in Ontario. Beavers and red squirrels both live in its forests and lakes.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/friendship-bridge

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What animals are these? What are they building?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 1

Why couldn't Venny and Sammy agree at first?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 2

What went wrong with each bridge when they built alone?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 3

What was good about Venny's idea? What was good about Sammy's?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 4

When have you and a friend had different ideas? What did you do?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 5

What could you build with someone else this week?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 6

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Teamwork hero

This is to say that

_____

showed teamwork, just like Venny.

Signed _____ Date _____

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